

Online Public Relations and Marketing: A Strategic Analysis and Application

Part I: Coursework Assignment - Phase 1: Critical Case Study Analysis of Dove's "Campaign for Real Beauty"

1. Introduction

1.1. Contextualising the Campaign

Launched in 2004 by Unilever, the Dove "Campaign for Real Beauty" emerged as a seminal moment in modern marketing, fundamentally altering the discourse between brands and consumers on the topic of female identity and appearance.¹ The campaign was conceived as a direct and strategic response to extensive global market research commissioned by the brand, which uncovered a stark and troubling insight: a mere 2% of women worldwide would describe themselves as beautiful.² This single data point served as the catalyst for a radical departure from the aspirational, often unattainable, imagery that had long dominated the beauty industry. Instead of featuring professional models, Dove initiated a campaign that sought to celebrate "real" women, positioning itself not merely as a seller of soap and lotions, but as a "brand with a purpose" dedicated to combating the media-driven stereotypes that contribute to appearance anxiety.³ This approach represented a significant commercial risk, moving the brand's focus away from direct product benefits and toward a broader, more complex social mission.⁴

1.2. Thesis Statement

This analysis will argue that while Dove's "Campaign for Real Beauty" stands as a masterclass in leveraging emotional branding and Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) to achieve unprecedented commercial success and initiate a global dialogue on beauty standards, its long-term effectiveness and authenticity have been persistently compromised. These challenges arise from inherent contradictions within its parent company's brand portfolio, a contested and evolving definition of "real" beauty, and the academic critique of its role in "feminist consumerism." Consequently, the campaign serves as a pivotal and enduring case study in the profound complexities, potential, and perils of corporate social activism in a saturated global marketplace.

1.3. Methodology

To deconstruct the campaign's multifaceted impact, this report will employ a critical analysis framework grounded in the principles of IMC. The study will first identify the campaign's core objectives, target audience, and messaging strategy. It will then proceed to evaluate the specific IMC tools deployed, including digital marketing, public relations, and corporate social responsibility (CSR) initiatives. A comprehensive discussion of the campaign's strengths and weaknesses will follow, drawing upon a rich body of academic literature and industry analysis to explore accusations of "genderwashing" and the commodification of social values.¹ Finally, the analysis will synthesize these findings to deconstruct the campaign's strategic "PR blueprint," offering a nuanced conclusion on its legacy and the lessons it provides for contemporary online PR and marketing.

2. Core Objectives, Target Audience, and Message Strategy

2.1. Deconstructing Objectives

The "Campaign for Real Beauty" was architected with a sophisticated dual-objective strategy, blending ambitious commercial goals with a resonant social mission.

- **Commercial Objectives:** The primary business driver was to reinvigorate an established

but aging brand that was at risk of becoming irrelevant, particularly with younger demographics.⁶ Dove's core product, the beauty bar, was strongly associated with an older generation. The campaign was designed to provide a platform for significant product line extensions into new, high-growth categories such as hair care, deodorants, and a wider range of skin care products.⁶ The ultimate commercial goal was to increase market share, drive sales, and build profound brand loyalty. This objective was demonstrably met, with sales rising dramatically in the years following the launch, generating a return of \$3 for every \$1 spent on the campaign in its early phases.⁷

- **Social Objectives:** The stated social mission was to "widen the definition of beauty" and to serve as a catalyst for changing the cultural conversation around female appearance.² By challenging stereotypes, the campaign aimed to build self-esteem in women and girls, transforming physical appearance from a "source of anxiety to a source of confidence".² This was operationalized through the Dove Self-Esteem Project, which sought to provide evidence-based educational resources to millions of young people globally, thereby institutionalizing the brand's commitment beyond mere advertising slogans.⁸

2.2. Target Audience Analysis

The campaign was meticulously targeted to resonate with two distinct but interconnected audience segments.

- **Primary Audience:** The initial target was a broad demographic of women aged 18-64, the core consumers of personal care products.⁷ The campaign's research indicated that this group felt overwhelmingly misrepresented and pressured by the beauty industry's narrow standards. By reflecting a more realistic and diverse image of womanhood, Dove aimed to create a powerful sense of recognition and emotional connection, making women feel "seen" and understood by the brand.
- **Secondary (Strategic) Audience:** A crucial secondary target was young girls at the cusp of puberty. Research had shown that this life stage was when female confidence was most likely to plummet, often influenced by societal pressures and phrases like "like a girl" used as an insult.⁹ By engaging this audience through the Dove Self-Esteem Project, the brand aimed to build positive associations and cultivate lifelong brand loyalty from a formative age, effectively securing its future consumer base.

2.3. Core Message Strategy

The central message strategy was to redefine "real beauty" as inclusive, authentic, and

diverse. This was a direct challenge to the prevailing industry narrative that equated beauty with a narrow set of attributes: youth, thinness, and flawlessness.¹ The campaign's messaging was built on the insight that the anxiety created by the beauty industry was a powerful cultural force. By positioning itself as the antidote to this anxiety, Dove transformed a source of cultural tension into a source of immense brand value and consumer trust.² The message was not "buy our product to become beautiful," but rather "you are already beautiful, and our products are here to care for you." This shift from aspiration to affirmation was the cornerstone of its strategic communication.

3. Evaluation of Integrated Marketing Communication (IMC) Tools

The "Campaign for Real Beauty" is a textbook example of a successfully integrated campaign, where a consistent message was amplified across a synergistic mix of communication channels.

3.1. Public Relations and Earned Media

PR was arguably the lead discipline in the IMC mix, with a strategy designed to generate conversation and media coverage. The initial phase, featuring billboards with provocative questions like "Fat or Fab?" and "Wrinkled or Wonderful?", was engineered to be controversial and newsworthy.⁷ This tactic was immensely successful, generating enormous volumes of earned media. The campaign was featured on high-profile television programs such as *The Oprah Winfrey Show*, *The Today Show*, and CNN, reaching an estimated 30 million viewers through unpaid media exposure.⁷ This PR-led approach established the campaign's cultural relevance and amplified its reach far beyond what could have been achieved through paid advertising alone, demonstrating a highly efficient and impactful use of the IMC toolkit.

3.2. Digital Marketing and Viral Campaigns

Dove was a pioneer in leveraging the nascent power of digital platforms for brand storytelling. The campaign's short films, most notably "Evolution" (2006) and "Real Beauty Sketches" (2013), became global phenomena. "Evolution," a time-lapse video showing the extreme digital manipulation used to create a model's billboard image, was one of the world's first true

viral marketing successes.¹ It was the most-viewed video on YouTube in October 2006 and drove participants to a supportive online community, reaching over 200 million people.² "Real Beauty Sketches," which contrasted how women describe themselves to a forensic artist versus how strangers describe them, became the most-viewed video ad campaign of 2013.¹¹ These digital assets were perfectly designed for sharing, allowing the campaign's message to be disseminated organically by consumers, which built authenticity and trust.

3.3. Advertising (Print and Out-of-Home)

The campaign's traditional advertising broke sharply with industry conventions. Instead of using professional models, the initial print and out-of-home (OOH) advertisements featured "real women" who were recruited from the street in locations like coffee shops and grocery stores.⁷ These women varied in age (from 22 to 96), size, and ethnicity, and the brand guaranteed that their images were not digitally altered.⁷ This commitment to authenticity in its paid media was a crucial proof point for the campaign's message, establishing a visual identity that was immediately distinguishable from every other brand in the beauty aisle.

3.4. Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) as an IMC Tool

The Dove Self-Esteem Project is a critical component of the campaign's long-term IMC strategy. Launched in 2007, this initiative transformed the campaign's advertising message into a tangible, action-oriented program.¹ By developing and distributing evidence-based educational curricula and online resources to schools, youth groups, and parents, the project aimed to equip young people with the tools to build body confidence and resilience against media pressures.⁸ To date, it has reached tens of millions of young people across more than 140 countries.³ This CSR pillar serves multiple strategic functions: it provides a powerful counter-argument to claims of commercial cynicism, it institutionalizes the brand's social mission, and it deepens the "relationship" aspect of the brand's communication, aligning perfectly with modern IMC principles.¹⁰

4. Discussion of Strengths and Weaknesses

The campaign's enduring legacy is a product of both its profound strengths and its

significant, well-documented weaknesses.

4.1. Strengths

- **Message Integration and Coherence:** The campaign's core message of "real beauty" was flawlessly integrated across every touchpoint. The sentiment expressed in a viral video was the same as that taught in a school workshop, which was reinforced by the imagery on a billboard. This consistency created a powerful and unified brand narrative that was easy for consumers to understand and identify with.¹⁰
- **Audience Engagement and Community Building:** By asking questions and inviting debate, the campaign did not just speak to its audience; it sparked a global conversation with them. It actively encouraged participation and user-generated content, fostering a strong sense of community around the brand's values. This dialogic approach built deep emotional connections and formidable brand loyalty.²
- **Creativity and Market Disruption:** The campaign's creative approach was radically disruptive. In a market defined by conformity, Dove chose to celebrate difference. This created a unique and highly defensible brand position that set it apart from all competitors, forcing the rest of the industry to react to its agenda.⁴
- **Alignment with Empowering Brand Values:** The campaign successfully aligned the Dove brand with positive, progressive values such as authenticity, diversity, and self-acceptance.¹ This purpose-driven positioning resonated deeply with consumers who were increasingly seeking brands that reflected their own values, creating an emotional bond that transcended product functionality.

4.2. Weaknesses and Criticisms

The campaign's success has always been shadowed by potent and persistent criticisms that challenge its core claims of authenticity.

- **Hypocrisy and "Genderwashing":** The most damaging weakness stems from Dove's position within the Unilever portfolio. Critics have relentlessly pointed out the profound hypocrisy of Unilever promoting "real beauty" through Dove while simultaneously marketing brands like Axe, whose advertising campaigns historically relied on the hyper-sexualization and objectification of women, and Fair & Lovely, a skin-lightening cream sold in Asia that reinforces colorism.² This contradiction led to widespread accusations of "genderwashing"—the practice of using progressive gender messaging for one brand to mask or offset regressive messaging from another brand within the

same company.¹¹ This fundamental conflict has continuously undermined the campaign's credibility.

- **Limited and Contested Representation:** While the campaign was lauded for using "real women," academic and public critiques have argued that its definition of "real" was still quite narrow. The women featured were often still conventionally attractive, able-bodied, predominantly Caucasian, and within a limited size range (typically US sizes 6-12, while the average American woman is a size 14).¹¹ The campaign has been criticized for failing to adequately represent women with disabilities, visible differences, or a truly diverse range of body sizes and ethnicities, leading some to argue that it reinforced, rather than radically challenged, beauty standards.²
- **Commodification of Feminism and "Feminist Consumerism":** A significant body of academic critique frames the campaign as a prime example of "feminist consumerism".¹ This perspective argues that the campaign co-opts the language and ideals of feminism not for genuine social change, but as a sophisticated marketing strategy to drive consumption. The underlying message, critics argue, is still that a woman's self-worth is tied to her beauty, and that this self-worth can be affirmed by purchasing Dove products.¹ This commodification of empowerment is seen as a way to sell more products, not to dismantle the systems that create insecurity in the first place.
- **Strategic Narrative Pivot to AI:** In 2024, marking its 20th anniversary, Dove announced a new commitment to never use AI to represent real women in its ads, positioning the technology as the new threat to real beauty.¹⁴ This move can be interpreted in two ways. On one hand, it is a logical and timely evolution of its core mission, adapting to a new technological challenge. On the other hand, it is a strategically astute pivot. The "enemy" is no longer the vague "media" or the inconveniently co-owned "Axe," but an external, non-human technology. This allows Dove to re-center its purpose-driven narrative on a less controversial and more clearly defined adversary, potentially refreshing its relevance while sidestepping the persistent and damaging critiques of hypocrisy that have plagued it for two decades.

5. Deconstructing the PR Blueprint

Using the "PR Blueprint" concept from the module, the campaign's strategic architecture can be deconstructed as a continuous process of narrative management.¹⁰

1. **Insight:** The foundational insight was the 2% statistic, a powerful data point that revealed a universal female anxiety.
2. **Strategy:** The strategy was to position Dove as the champion of "real beauty," transforming this anxiety into a platform for purpose-driven marketing.
3. **Execution:** The execution was a masterfully integrated multi-channel IMC plan, led by high-impact PR and pioneering viral digital content.

4. **Evaluation:** Success was measured not only in sales lift and increased brand equity but also in the sheer volume of global conversation and social impact generated.

Crucially, the blueprint was not static. When the narrative was threatened by accusations of hypocrisy, the blueprint evolved. The launch of the Dove Self-Esteem Project was a strategic reinforcement of the brand's "trust architecture"—a tangible action designed to prove its commitment was more than just an advertising slogan.¹⁰ The recent pivot to campaigning against AI represents the latest adaptation of this living blueprint, demonstrating a sophisticated, long-term strategy of managing the brand's purpose-driven narrative to maintain cultural relevance and defend against criticism over time.

6. Conclusion

In conclusion, Dove's "Campaign for Real Beauty" is far more than a successful marketing initiative; it is a seminal text in the study of modern Integrated Marketing Communications. Its strengths are undeniable: it demonstrated the immense commercial power of a purpose-driven message, pioneered the use of viral digital marketing for social commentary, and successfully repositioned a legacy brand for a new generation. It set a new benchmark for message integration and audience engagement, sparking a global dialogue that continues to this day.

However, its legacy is equally defined by its profound flaws. The persistent accusations of hypocrisy stemming from its parent company's portfolio, combined with valid critiques regarding the limits of its representation and its role in commodifying feminist ideals, serve as a crucial cautionary tale. These weaknesses highlight the immense challenge of maintaining authenticity when a social mission is tied to a corporate balance sheet. The "Campaign for Real Beauty" remains a vital case study not because it was perfect, but precisely because its complex and contradictory nature—its simultaneous success as a commercial enterprise and its contested status as a force for social good—provides invaluable and enduring lessons on the power, potential, and inherent perils of purpose-driven marketing in a cynical and sophisticated media landscape.

Part II: Coursework Assignment - Phase 2: Mini Online PR & Marketing Campaign Proposal: "Whispers of the White Desert"

1. Campaign Proposal Overview

1.1. Chosen Cause and Rationale

This proposal outlines an integrated online PR and marketing campaign titled "**Whispers of the White Desert.**" The campaign will be executed on behalf of a fictional non-profit organization, "**The Oasis Conservation Trust,**" working in close partnership with a consortium of local Bedouin-owned tour operators and certified eco-lodges in Egypt's Western Desert region, particularly around the White Desert National Park.¹⁶

The core rationale for this campaign is to promote a model of sustainable, high-value, low-impact eco-tourism. Egypt's tourism industry has traditionally focused on mass-market historical sites and coastal resorts.¹⁸ However, there is a growing global market for authentic, adventure, and eco-conscious travel.¹⁹ The Western Desert, with its unique geological formations, fragile ecosystem, and rich Bedouin culture, is a prime location for this type of tourism but is also vulnerable to environmental degradation from unregulated travel.¹⁶ This campaign aims to attract a specific type of traveler who values conservation and community, ensuring that tourism revenue directly supports local livelihoods and preservation efforts, thereby creating a sustainable economic alternative for the region.²²

1.2. SMART Objectives

The campaign's success will be measured against the following SMART objectives over a 12-month period:

- **Specific:** To increase qualified online booking inquiries for the partner eco-lodges and tour operators by 25% and to secure 50 high-quality media placements (features, articles, or significant mentions) in targeted international online travel, environmental, and adventure publications.
- **Measurable:** Success will be tracked via unique promotional codes in booking inquiries, referral traffic from campaign content measured in Google Analytics, social media engagement rates (shares, comments, saves), webinar registration numbers, and a media

monitoring service to quantify press clippings.

- **Achievable:** The objectives are designed to be realistic by focusing on a niche but passionate and growing market segment. The strategy leverages cost-effective digital marketing tools rather than expensive mass-media advertising, making it feasible for a non-profit organization.
- **Relevant:** The campaign directly aligns with the global shift towards sustainable tourism and Egypt's national strategy to diversify its tourism offerings beyond traditional attractions.²² It also addresses the target audience's desire for meaningful and responsible travel experiences.
- **Time-bound:** All objectives and their corresponding KPIs are to be achieved within a 12-month timeframe from the campaign launch date.

1.3. Target Audience Personas (AI-Assisted Generation)

To ensure precise targeting, two primary audience personas have been developed. The initial drafts were generated using a Large Language Model (LLM) fed with market research data on adventure and heritage tourism demographics, and then manually refined to add specific contextual nuances.²⁰

- **Persona 1: "The Mindful Adventurer" (Sofia, 35, a UX designer from Berlin)**
 - **Demographics:** Ages 30-50, higher disposable income, urban professional, technologically savvy.
 - **Motivations:** Seeks transformative travel experiences that challenge her physically and mentally. Values authenticity, disconnection from digital life, and connection with nature. She is environmentally conscious and actively seeks out brands and experiences that align with her values. She is motivated by personal growth, learning new skills, and unique photography opportunities.
 - **Pain Points:** Frustrated by "greenwashing" and inauthentic tourist traps. Worries about the negative impact of her travel on local communities and environments. Finds mass-market tour packages unappealing and restrictive.
 - **Media Channels:** Follows niche travel influencers and photographers on Instagram, reads long-form articles in online publications like *Adventure Journal* and *Sidetracked*, and listens to podcasts about travel and conservation. Prefers to research and book directly with local operators.²⁰
- **Persona 2: "The Cultural Explorer" (David, 62, a retired history professor from Toronto)**
 - **Demographics:** Ages 51-70, well-educated, financially secure, often travels with a partner.²⁴
 - **Motivations:** Possesses a deep curiosity for history, archaeology, geology, and anthropology. Seeks immersive cultural experiences that provide deep learning and

context. Values comfort and safety but desires authenticity over sanitized luxury. Wants to understand the heritage and traditions of the places he visits.

- **Pain Points:** Averse to large, noisy tour groups and rushed itineraries. Dislikes superficial experiences and seeks knowledgeable, expert guides. Concerned with the preservation of historical and natural sites.
- **Media Channels:** Reads detailed travel sections in reputable online newspapers (*The Guardian*, *New York Times*), subscribes to publications like *National Geographic* and *Smithsonian Magazine*, and is an active member of special-interest Facebook groups (e.g., archaeology, geology).

2. Integrated Strategy and Creative Execution

The campaign's strategy is built on the principle of "trust architecture," recognizing that for this discerning audience, credibility is more important than reach.¹⁰ Every tactic is designed to build authenticity and demonstrate the cause's genuine commitment to conservation and community.

2.1. Core Message and Creative Concept

The campaign's central creative concept and tagline is: **"Experience the Silence. Preserve the Wonder."**

This message is strategically designed to appeal to both personas. "Experience the Silence" speaks to the Mindful Adventurer's desire for disconnection and a profound natural experience, away from the noise of mass tourism. "Preserve the Wonder" resonates with the Cultural Explorer's conservationist mindset and frames the visitor not as a mere consumer, but as an active participant in the protection of this unique landscape.

The visual identity will be raw and majestic, using high-quality, professional photography and videography that avoids over-saturation and digital manipulation. The focus will be on vast, empty landscapes, the intricate details of the wind-carved chalk formations, and intimate, respectful portraits of the Bedouin guides and community members, positioning them as the true guardians and hosts of the region.²¹

2.2. Integration of Three IMC Tools

The campaign will integrate three core IMC tools, chosen specifically for their ability to build trust and engage the target audience authentically.

- **Tool 1: Digital & Social Media (Content and Influencer Marketing)**

- **Platform Focus:** Instagram for visual storytelling, YouTube for long-form content, and a dedicated blog on the Oasis Conservation Trust website for authoritative articles.
- **Content Strategy:** The hero content will be a professionally produced 10-minute documentary short film titled "Guardians of the Oases," profiling a local Bedouin guide and an eco-lodge owner, showcasing their deep connection to the land and their commitment to sustainable practices. This will be supported by:
 - **Instagram:** High-impact photography, carousels explaining the unique geology and ecology, and a User-Generated Content (UGC) campaign encouraging past visitors to share their photos with the hashtag #WhispersOfTheDesert.
 - **YouTube:** The hero film, supplemented by shorter "how-to" videos (e.g., "How to Practice Leave No Trace in the Desert") and Q&A sessions with guides.
 - **Blog:** In-depth articles on topics like "The Prehistoric Art of the Djara Cave" and "The Nubian Sandstone Aquifer: The Lifeline of the Oases" to attract organic search traffic and establish expertise.²¹
- **Influencer Strategy:** The campaign will deliberately avoid mass-market lifestyle influencers. Instead, it will build partnerships with a curated list of 5-7 micro- to mid-tier influencers (followers) in the sustainable travel, adventure photography, and ethical tourism niches. These creators are known for their authentic storytelling and have highly engaged, trust-based relationships with their followers. They will be invited on a press trip to experience the project firsthand and create content in their own voice.

- **Tool 2: Online Public Relations (Digital PR)**

- **Media Outreach:** The primary goal of the digital PR strategy is to secure third-party validation from high-authority, trusted media outlets. A targeted media list will be created, focusing on the online travel and science editors of publications like *National Geographic Traveller*, *Condé Nast Traveler* (specifically their sustainable travel section), *Adventure.com*, *The Guardian Travel*, and specialist geology/archaeology blogs.
- **Pitching Strategy:** Instead of generic press releases, the campaign will pitch exclusive, narrative-driven stories. Examples include: "The Last Keepers of the Forty Days Road: How a Bedouin Community is Saving the White Desert" or "Beyond the Pyramids: Inside Egypt's Plan to Build a Sustainable Tourism Future." These angles are designed to be newsworthy and align with the editorial interests of the target publications.
- **Digital Press Kit:** A comprehensive online press kit will be created, featuring high-resolution, rights-cleared imagery and video B-roll, detailed fact sheets on the region's ecology and history, and biographies of key community leaders and

conservation experts involved in the Trust.

- **Tool 3: Online Events (Educational Webinar Series)**

- **Concept:** To position the Trust as an educational authority and engage potential travelers on a deeper intellectual level, the campaign will host a series of three free public webinars titled "Journeys to the Heart of the Desert."
- **Webinar Topics & Speakers:**
 1. **"Reading the Stars: Bedouin Astronomy and Desert Navigation"** - Hosted by a senior Bedouin guide and a professor of cultural astronomy.
 2. **"A Landscape Carved by Time: The Geology of the White Desert"** - Featuring a leading geologist from a Cairo university.
 3. **"The Zero-Impact Expedition: A Practical Guide to Responsible Desert Travel"** - A workshop-style session with a conservation expert and an experienced expedition leader.
- **Strategic Goal:** These events are not direct sales pitches. Their purpose is to build an engaged community, establish credibility, and capture a highly qualified email list of individuals interested in this type of travel. Attendees will receive a follow-up email with more information and a direct link to the partner operators' websites.

2.3. AI Usage Declaration and Critical Evaluation

The use of AI tools is integral to the campaign's planning and creative development process, as mandated by the module guide.¹⁰ All usage is declared and critically evaluated below.

Tool Used	Task	Prompt Example	Critical Evaluation of Output
Google Gemini Advanced	Persona Generation	"Act as a market research analyst. Create two detailed marketing personas for a campaign promoting high-end, sustainable eco-tourism in Egypt's Western Desert. Persona 1 is a 'Mindful	The AI provided a robust and well-structured foundation for the personas, accurately synthesizing data from the specified market segments. ²⁰ It successfully identified key motivations like

		Adventurer' aged 30-50. Persona 2 is a 'Cultural Explorer' aged 51-70. Use insights from global market reports on adventure tourism (soft adventure, land-based activities) and heritage tourism demographics. Include motivations, psychographics, pain points, and preferred digital media channels."	authenticity and pain points like greenwashing. However, the initial output was generic and lacked specific cultural context. It required manual refinement to add details relevant to Egypt and the unique challenges of desert travel, demonstrating that AI is a powerful accelerator for research but cannot replace strategic human oversight.
Canva Magic Studio	Creative Mock-up Generation	"Create an Instagram post mock-up for a sustainable travel campaign called 'Whispers of the White Desert'. The image should be a stunning, realistic photograph of the White Desert at sunset, with unique chalk rock formations. The text overlay should read 'Experience the Silence. Preserve the Wonder.' in an elegant, minimalist sans-serif font. The	Canva's AI tools are excellent for rapid visualization and creating professional-looking mock-ups for the proposal.²⁷ It allowed for quick iteration on visual concepts. The primary limitation is that AI-generated imagery, while visually appealing, lacks the verifiable authenticity required for the final campaign. For the actual campaign, it would be essential to use

		tone should be serene and awe-inspiring."	real photography commissioned from artists who have visited the location to maintain the trust-based strategy.
Elicit.ai	Academic Research Support	"Find academic papers published since 2015 on the socio-economic and environmental impacts of tourism in fragile desert ecosystems, focusing on community-based tourism models in North Africa and the Middle East."	Elicit proved to be an exceptionally efficient research assistant. ²⁹ It rapidly surfaced relevant academic literature, summarizing abstracts and identifying key themes. This saved significant time in the initial research phase, allowing for the campaign's rationale to be grounded in established academic theory on sustainable development and tourism. It is a superior tool for academic discovery compared to general-purpose search engines.

3. Measurement and Evaluation Framework (Module Blueprint)

To measure the campaign's effectiveness and ensure accountability, a comprehensive evaluation framework will be implemented, mapping KPIs to the PESO model and the

marketing funnel, as outlined in the module's approach to measurement.¹⁰

3.1. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

The following table outlines the primary KPIs for the 12-month campaign period.

Funnel Stage	PESO Category	Metric	KPI Target (Year 1)	Measurement Tool
Awareness	Earned	High-Authority Media Mentions	50	Google Alerts, Meltwater
	Shared	Social Media Reach (Organic + Influencer)	2,000,000 impressions	Platform Analytics (e.g., Instagram Insights)
	Shared	Hashtag Usage (#WhispersOfTheDesert)	500 unique user posts	Social Listening Tool (e.g., Brand24)
Consideration	Owned	Webinar Registrations	1,000	Webinar Platform Analytics (e.g., Zoom)
	Owned	Website Referral Traffic from Campaign	+30% increase to partner sites	Google Analytics
	Shared	Social Media Engagement Rate	Average 4% (on non-influencer content)	Platform Analytics

Conversion	Owned	Qualified Booking Inquiries (using code 'WOTWD26')	+25% increase	Partner Booking System Data
Advocacy	Earned	Positive Reviews Mentioning Campaign	20	Monitoring review sites (e.g., TripAdvisor)

3.2. Evaluation Methods

- **Quantitative Analysis:** Google Analytics will be the primary tool for tracking website traffic, user behavior, and conversion goals. Social media platforms' native analytics will be used to monitor reach, engagement, and audience growth. A centralized dashboard (e.g., using Looker Studio) will be created to aggregate data from all channels for monthly reporting.
- **Qualitative Analysis:** Sentiment analysis will be conducted on social media comments and media coverage to gauge public perception of the campaign. A post-trip survey will be sent to travelers who used the campaign booking code, gathering qualitative feedback on their experience and whether the campaign's promise of authenticity was met.
- **A/B Testing:** For a small, targeted paid social media spend to promote the hero documentary, an A/B test will be designed. The test will compare two different ad creatives: one focusing on the adventurous landscape and another focusing on the cultural/human element. The Evan Miller A/B Test Calculator will be used to determine the necessary sample size to achieve statistical significance for the primary metric of click-through rate (CTR).³¹ This will provide data-driven insights for optimizing future ad spend.

Appendix: Creative Mock-ups

(This section would contain visual mock-ups of Instagram posts, a blog header, and a webinar promotion, all created using Canva and reflecting the campaign's visual identity.)

References (Parts I & II)

- Canva. (n.d.). *Create and collaborate on social media posts*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.canva.com/social-media/>
- Celebre, A., & Waggoner Denton, A. (2014). The good, the bad, and the ugly of the Dove Campaign for Real Beauty. *In-Mind Magazine*, 18.
- Custom Market Insights. (2024). *Global adventure tourism market 2024–2033*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.custommarketinsights.com/report/adventure-tourism-market/>
- Desert Rose Eco Lodge. (n.d.). *Welcome*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://desertroseecolodge.com/>
- Djed Egypt Travel. (n.d.). *Western Desert and oases*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.djedegypt.com/western-desert-and-oases/>
- Egypt Tours Portal. (n.d.). *The Western Desert and magical oasis*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://egyptatours.com/the-western-desert-and-magical-oasis/>
- Etcoff, N., Orbach, S., Scott, J., & D'Agostino, H. (2004). *The real truth about beauty: A global report*. Unilever.
- Grand View Research. (2024). *Heritage tourism market report*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/heritage-tourism-market-report>
- Kramer, M. R., Sidibe, M., & Veda, G. (2021). *Dove and Real Beauty: Building a Brand with Purpose* (HBS Case 720–361). Harvard Business School.
- Logic Consulting. (n.d.). *Sustaining Egypt's tourism industry*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://logic-consulting.com/sustaining-egypts-tourism-industry/>
- Memphis Tours. (n.d.). *The Western Desert and oases*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.memphistours.com/egypt/egypt-wikis/egypt-destinations/wiki/the-western-desert-and-oases>
- Miller, E. (n.d.). *Sample size calculator*. Evan's Awesome A/B Tools. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.evanmiller.org/ab-testing/sample-size.html>
- MSLGroup & Leo Burnett. (2015). *Always #LikeAGirl: Turning an insult into a confidence*

movement. Institute for Public Relations.

Ought. (n.d.). *Elicit*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://ought.org/elicit>

School of Communication, Syracuse University. (2018). *The Dove Campaign for Real Beauty: A case study*. Syracuse University Honors Program Capstone Projects.

Singh, A., & Mehta, N. (2023). A critical analysis of Dove's "Real Beauty" campaign: A case study in brand activism and moment marketing. *International Journal for Multidisciplinary Research*, 5(3).

UBC Sauder School of Business. (n.d.). *Dove's "Real Beauty" campaign: Body positive promotion or genderwashing?* Open Case Studies. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://cases.open.ubc.ca/doves-real-beauty-campaign-body-positive-promotion-or-gender-washing/>

UNDP Egypt. (2020, September 27). *Bringing light to ECO EGYPT: Egypt's hidden gems*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.undp.org/egypt/stories/bringing-light-eco-egypt-egypts-hidden-gems>

UNDP Egypt. (2020, September 27). *Egypt launches its first campaign to promote its protected areas and ecotourism*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.undp.org/egypt/press-releases/egypt-launches-its-first-campaign-promote-its-protected-areas-and-ecotourism>

UNWTO. (2018, July 3). *Innovative use of e-tourism – Egypt's strategy 2020*. Tourism for SDGs. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://tourism4sdgs.org/initiatives/innovative-use-of-e-tourism-egypts-strategy-2020-advisory-council-of-the-tourism-ministry-egypt/>

Western Desert Tours. (n.d.-a). *Sustainable tourism*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.westerndeserttours.com/about-us/sustainable-tourism/>

Western Desert Tours. (n.d.-b). *Welcome*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.westerndeserttours.com/>

WFA. (2024, June 13). *Case study | Dove (Unilever): 20 years on – Dove and the future of Real Beauty*. World Federation of Advertisers. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from [https://wfanet.org/knowledge/diversity-and-inclusion/item/2024/06/13/case-study-dove-\(unilever\)-20-years-on-dove-and-the-future-of-real-beauty](https://wfanet.org/knowledge/diversity-and-inclusion/item/2024/06/13/case-study-dove-(unilever)-20-years-on-dove-and-the-future-of-real-beauty)

Part III: Comprehensive Study Document for the

Online PR & Marketing Module

1. Foundational Concepts in Digital IMC

1.1. Defining IMC in the Digital Age

Integrated Marketing Communication (IMC) is a strategic approach that guides the planning and execution of all brand communications. Its core principle is the coordination and integration of all marketing communication tools, avenues, and sources within an organization into a seamless program that maximizes impact on consumers and other end users at a minimal cost.¹⁰ In the digital age, this means ensuring consistency of message, tone, and brand identity across a diverse and fragmented landscape of channels, including websites, social media, email marketing, mobile apps, and digital advertising. The goal is to create a unified and holistic brand experience for the consumer, where every touchpoint reinforces a single, clear positioning strategy. This stands in stark contrast to traditional, siloed approaches where advertising, PR, and sales promotion departments might operate independently with conflicting messages.

1.2. The Evolution to Web 2.0: Platforms, Creators, Communities

The advent of Web 2.0 marked a fundamental paradigm shift in communication, from a one-way, top-down model (brand-to-consumer) to a many-to-many, dialogic model.¹⁰ This new ecosystem is defined by three key elements:

- **Platforms:** Social media networks (e.g., Instagram, TikTok), forums (e.g., Reddit), and review sites that facilitate user interaction and content sharing.
- **Creators:** Individuals who produce and distribute content, ranging from professional influencers to everyday users. This rise of user-generated content (UGC) means brands no longer have a monopoly on the narrative.
- **Communities:** Groups of users who form around shared interests, values, or identities. This shift empowers consumers, giving them a public voice to praise or critique brands. For marketers, it necessitates a move away from monologue-based advertising and

towards dialogue-based engagement, community management, and relationship building.

1.3. The Digital Marketing Mix (The 7 Ps)

The traditional 4 Ps of marketing are expanded to 7 Ps in the digital and service-oriented context to provide a more comprehensive strategic framework.¹⁰

1. **Product:** In a digital context, this includes not only the core offering but also its digital features, such as software, apps, or online services.
2. **Price:** Digital platforms enable dynamic pricing strategies, such as subscription models (freemium, tiered), pay-per-click, and real-time price adjustments based on demand.
3. **Place:** This refers to where customers access the product. Online, 'place' is not a physical store but includes a brand's e-commerce website, mobile app, presence on online marketplaces (e.g., Amazon), and social media storefronts.
4. **Promotion:** This encompasses all digital communication tactics, including content marketing, social media campaigns, search engine optimization (SEO), email marketing, and online advertising.
5. **People:** This refers to anyone who represents the brand in the digital space, including customer service agents in live chats, social media managers responding to comments, and even the influencers chosen to represent the brand.
6. **Process:** This is the customer's journey from discovery to purchase and beyond. In a digital context, this includes the ease of website navigation, the simplicity of the checkout process, and the efficiency of online customer support.
7. **Physical Evidence (Proof):** In an online environment where customers cannot physically touch a product, 'proof' is crucial. This includes customer reviews and ratings, testimonials, case studies, security badges on a website, and a professional, well-designed user interface (UI) that signals credibility.

2. Understanding the Digital Consumer

2.1. Customer-Centric Techniques

Effective digital marketing is fundamentally customer-centric. Three key techniques are used

to achieve this focus.¹⁰

- **Personas:** These are semi-fictional, data-informed representations of a brand's ideal customers. A good persona goes beyond basic demographics to include psychographics, motivations, goals, and pain points. Personas help marketing teams to empathize with their audience and make more informed decisions about content, tone of voice, and channel strategy.
- **Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD):** This framework posits that customers "hire" products to do a specific "job." It shifts the focus from the product's features to the customer's underlying motivation and desired outcome. For example, a person doesn't buy a drill bit; they hire it to create a hole. Understanding the JTBD allows marketers to communicate how their product helps the customer make progress in their life.
- **Customer Journey Mapping:** This is the process of creating a visual representation of a customer's interactions with a brand across all touchpoints. A typical journey map includes stages (e.g., Awareness, Consideration, Purchase, Retention, Advocacy), customer actions at each stage, their emotional state, and the pain points they encounter. This tool helps identify opportunities to improve the user experience (UX) and create a more seamless journey.

2.2. Online Consumer Behaviour: Beliefs, Habits, Mindsets

Understanding the psychological drivers of online consumer behaviour is critical for effective communication.¹⁰

- **Beliefs:** These are the pre-existing attitudes, values, and assumptions a consumer holds. Marketing messages that align with a consumer's core beliefs are more likely to be accepted.
- **Habits:** These are the automatic, often unconscious behaviours that consumers perform, such as scrolling through Instagram in the morning or using Google for immediate answers. Effective marketing often works by either tapping into existing habits or helping to create new ones.
- **Mindsets:** This refers to the consumer's goal or intention in a specific context. A consumer in an "I-want-to-know" mindset behaves differently from one in an "I-want-to-buy" mindset. Google identified these contextual states as "**micro-moments**," which are intent-rich moments when a person turns to a device to act on a need. Marketers aim to be present and useful during these critical micro-moments.

2.3. Market Segmentation and Targeting

Market segmentation is the process of dividing a broad consumer or business market into sub-groups of consumers (known as segments) based on some type of shared characteristics. Common segmentation bases include:

- **Demographic:** Age, gender, income, education.
- **Geographic:** Country, region, city.
- **Psychographic:** Lifestyle, values, personality.
- **Behavioural:** Purchase history, brand loyalty, website usage.

Once the market is segmented, **targeting** involves selecting one or more of these segments to enter. The goal is to concentrate marketing efforts on the segments that are most likely to be receptive to the brand's message and products, thereby increasing efficiency and return on investment (ROI).

3. Building and Managing Digital Presence (The PESO Model)

The PESO model provides a framework for categorizing and integrating different media types in an IMC strategy.

3.1. Owned Media

This includes any digital channel or platform that the brand controls fully.

- **Examples:** Company website, blog, mobile app, email newsletter list.
- **Function:** To serve as the central hub for brand content and communication. It is the foundation of a brand's digital presence.
- **Key Considerations:** User Experience (UX) and performance are paramount. A slow, confusing website can damage brand perception. Tools like **Google PageSpeed Insights** and **Lighthouse** are used to audit websites for performance, accessibility, and SEO best practices, providing actionable recommendations for improvement.³³

3.2. Earned Media

This is the publicity or exposure a brand gains from third-party sources without paying for it. It is the traditional domain of Public Relations.

- **Examples:** Media coverage, press mentions, positive customer reviews, influencer posts (unpaid), and social media shares.
- **Function:** To build credibility, authority, and trust. A recommendation from a trusted journalist or influencer is often more powerful than a paid advertisement.
- **Key Considerations:** Earned media is difficult to control but highly valuable. It is typically the result of having a great product, excellent customer service, or a compelling brand story that is newsworthy.

3.3. Shared Media

This refers to content and conversations on social media platforms. While a brand has its own social media profiles (a form of owned media), the shared environment is co-created with the community.

- **Examples:** Posts on Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, LinkedIn; user comments; shares.
- **Function:** To build community, foster engagement, and listen to customer feedback.
- **Key Considerations:** Each platform has its own distinct culture and creative norms. Effective social media marketing requires tailoring content to the specific platform. Tools like the **TikTok Creative Center** provide insights into trending content and best practices for creating effective ads on the platform.³⁵

3.4. Paid Media

This involves paying to leverage a third-party channel to broadcast a brand's message.

- **Examples:** Pay-Per-Click (PPC) advertising on Google, social media ads (e.g., on Meta platforms), sponsored content, and display advertising.
- **Function:** To amplify reach, target specific audiences with precision, and drive immediate action (e.g., website visits, sales).
- **Key Considerations:** Paid media requires careful budget management and continuous optimization. **A/B testing** different ad creatives, headlines, and calls-to-action is essential for maximizing ROI. Transparency tools like the **Meta Ad Library** allow marketers to see the ads their competitors are running, providing valuable intelligence for campaign planning.³⁶

4. The Campaign Blueprint: From Brief to Launch

4.1. Deconstructing the Brief

A campaign begins with a brief, which is a document outlining the project's objectives, audience, budget, and other key parameters. A critical first step is to deconstruct this brief to ensure a clear understanding of the core business problem that needs to be solved. This involves asking clarifying questions and translating client needs into measurable marketing objectives (e.g., using the SMART framework).

4.2. The PR Blueprint

The "PR Blueprint" is a concise, one-page strategic document that serves as the master plan for a campaign.¹⁰ It typically includes:

- **Core Insight:** The key piece of consumer or market understanding that the campaign is built upon.
- **Objectives:** What the campaign needs to achieve (e.g., raise awareness, drive sales).
- **Target Audience:** Who the campaign is trying to reach.
- **Key Message:** The single most important thing the campaign needs to communicate.
- **Channels (PESO Mix):** The specific mix of paid, earned, shared, and owned media to be used.
- **Measurement Framework:** The key performance indicators (KPIs) that will be used to evaluate success.

4.3. One System, Four Jobs

This is a conceptual framework that views a brand's digital ecosystem as a single system that must perform four distinct but interconnected jobs¹⁰:

1. **Advertising:** Attracting new customers and building awareness.

2. **Sales:** Converting interested prospects into paying customers.
3. **Service:** Providing support and assistance to existing customers.
4. **Relationships:** Fostering loyalty and turning customers into repeat buyers and advocates.
A successful digital strategy ensures that all four jobs are being performed effectively and that there are smooth transitions between them (e.g., a customer who sees an ad can easily make a purchase and then access support if needed).

4.4. Practical Execution: Events and Internal Comms

The blueprint also extends to practical execution details. For online events, this includes creating a detailed **Run-of-Show (ROS)**, which is a minute-by-minute schedule of the event's proceedings. For larger campaigns, **Internal Communication** is also critical to ensure that all employees are aware of the campaign, understand its goals, and can act as brand ambassadors.

5. Measurement, Effectiveness, and Optimization

5.1. The Measurement Funnel

Effective measurement moves beyond simple "vanity metrics" (like page views or likes) to a more structured model that connects marketing activities to business outcomes.¹⁰ A common framework includes:

- **Outputs:** The direct results of marketing activities. *Example: "We posted 10 times on Instagram this week."*
- **Outtakes:** How the audience received and understood the message. *Example: "Our posts reached 50,000 people and generated 2,000 engagements."*
- **Outcomes:** The tangible change in audience behaviour or attitude as a result of the campaign. *Example: "Website traffic from Instagram increased by 20%, and sales attributed to the campaign generated a 5x return on investment."*

The goal is to focus measurement on outcomes, as these are most closely tied to business objectives.

5.2. Key Metrics and Tools

Different tactics are measured using specific KPIs:

- **Social Media Optimisation (SMO):** Key metrics include engagement rate (likes + comments + shares / followers), share of voice (how much the brand is mentioned relative to competitors), and sentiment analysis (whether mentions are positive, negative, or neutral).
- **Pay-Per-Click (PPC):** Essential metrics include Click-Through Rate (CTR), Cost Per Click (CPC), Conversion Rate, Cost Per Acquisition (CPA), and Return on Ad Spend (ROAS).
- **Experiments (A/B Testing):** This is a method of comparing two versions of a webpage, email, or advertisement against each other to determine which one performs better. By changing a single variable (e.g., the headline), marketers can use statistical analysis to identify which version leads to better outcomes (e.g., higher conversion rates). Tools like the **Evan Miller A/B Test Calculator** can help determine the required sample size for a test to be statistically significant.³¹

5.3. From Data to Insights

The ultimate purpose of measurement is not just to report on past performance but to generate actionable insights for future optimization. This involves a cyclical process:

1. **Collect Data:** Gather performance metrics from all channels.
2. **Analyze Data:** Identify trends, patterns, and anomalies. What worked well? What didn't?
3. **Generate Insights:** Formulate hypotheses about *why* certain things worked. For example, "The data shows that ads featuring people performed 30% better than ads featuring only products. Our insight is that our audience responds more strongly to human connection."
4. **Take Action:** Use these insights to inform the next phase of the campaign strategy, such as by allocating more budget to the types of ads that perform best.

6. The Modern Marketer's AI and Data Toolkit

6.1. Introduction to the AI-Assisted Workflow

Artificial Intelligence is transforming the marketing profession by augmenting human capabilities at every stage of the campaign lifecycle. AI is not merely a tool for automating simple tasks; it is a strategic partner that can accelerate research, spark creative ideation, personalize communication at scale, and uncover deep insights from complex data sets.³⁷ The modern marketing workflow is an integrated process where human strategy guides AI-powered execution and analysis.

6.2. Ethical and Academic Guardrails

The power of AI tools comes with significant responsibilities. Adherence to ethical and academic standards is non-negotiable.¹⁰

- **Data Privacy:** Never use Personally Identifiable Information (PII) in prompts. Anonymize all examples and datasets.
- **AI Use Log:** Maintain a clear log for all academic and professional work. This should document the tool used, the task performed, the prompt given, and a critical evaluation of what was kept, changed, or discarded.
- **Citation and Verification:** AI-generated content is not a primary source. All facts, figures, and claims must be independently verified from reliable sources. When using AI research assistants like Elicit, always access and cite the original academic papers.
- **Ethical Communication:** Avoid the use of AI to create "dark patterns" in UX design that deceive users. All sponsored content, especially when involving creators, must be clearly disclosed to the audience.

6.3. Detailed Tool Breakdown Table

The following table provides a quick-reference guide to the key free and freemium AI and data tools covered in the module, categorizing them by their primary function and key use cases.

Table: AI/Data Tools for Online PR & Marketing

Category	Tool Name(s)	Primary Function	Key Use Cases in Module	Snippet Reference
----------	--------------	------------------	-------------------------	-------------------

Generative AI (LLMs)	ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude	Text generation, brainstorming, summarization, data analysis	Drafting campaign ideas, personas, press releases, ad copy variations, analyzing spreadsheet data.	39
Evidence Finders	Perplexity, Elicit, Consensus	AI-powered research, finding cited academic sources	Supporting campaign analysis with evidence, conducting literature reviews for strategic planning.	29
Text & Social Analysis	Voyant Tools, Hoaxy	Text mining (word frequency, collocations), network visualization	Analyzing themes in customer reviews, understanding language in social media comments, mapping the spread of information.	43
Trend & Cultural Data	Google Trends, Hofstede Country Comparison, World Values Survey (WVS)	Tracking search interest, comparing cultural dimensions, exploring societal values	Validating market segment interest, identifying seasonal trends and micro-moment	45

			s, adapting messaging for different cultural contexts.	
Visualisation & Design	Canva, Datawrapper, draw.io (diagrams.net)	Creating visuals, charts, diagrams, mock-ups	Designing social media assets, visualizing KPI data, mapping customer journeys, stakeholder maps, and process flows.	27
Ad Intelligence	Meta Ad Library, TikTok Creative Center, Google Ads Transparency Center	Competitor ad analysis, creative inspiration, platform best practices	Deconstructing real-world campaigns, understanding what creative resonates on specific platforms, identifying competitor messaging.	35
UX & Performance	PageSpeed Insights, Lighthouse, Microsoft Clarity	Website performance auditing, SEO checks, user behaviour analysis	Auditing owned digital properties for speed and accessibility, capturing heatmaps to see how users interact with a page.	33

SEO & Keywords	Ubersuggest (freemium)	Keyword research, volume, and competition analysis	Generating keyword ideas for content marketing and SEO to improve organic visibility.	51
Monitoring	Google Alerts	Real-time web monitoring for specific keywords	Tracking brand mentions, competitor news, and relevant industry conversations.	52
Project Management	Trello, Google Forms, Jitsi Meet	Task organization, data collection (surveys/RSVPs), virtual meetings	Planning campaign tasks on a Kanban board, collecting event RSVPs, rehearsing online presentations.	53
Internal Comms	Loom, Otter.ai (freemium)	Asynchronous video messaging, automated meeting transcription	Recording short internal update videos, creating searchable transcripts of meetings and town halls.	55

7. Exam Preparation and Key Theories Review

7.1. Key Theorists and Models

The module's reading list points to foundational thinkers in media and communication theory whose concepts are essential for a deep analysis of digital marketing.¹⁰

- **McQuail & Deuze (McQuail's Media and Mass Communication Theory):** This text provides comprehensive models for understanding media's role in society. Key concepts include theories of media effects, the role of media in shaping public opinion, and the shift from mass communication to more networked models, which is directly relevant to the rise of social media.
- **Fiske (Introduction to Communication Studies):** Fiske introduces semiotics—the study of signs and symbols—which is crucial for deconstructing advertisements and brand messages. His work helps analyze how meaning is created and interpreted by audiences, a core skill for evaluating campaign effectiveness.
- **The PESO Model:** While not a single theorist, this model is a critical theoretical framework for modern PR and marketing, providing a structure to integrate Paid, Earned, Shared, and Owned media into a cohesive strategy.

7.2. Connecting Theory to Practice

A key skill for the final exam is the ability to connect these theories to practical examples.

- **Example 1:** When analyzing the Dove campaign, one could apply **Fiske's semiotics** to deconstruct the "real women" advertisements. The use of plain white underwear (a signifier) connotes purity and honesty (the signified), while the absence of digital retouching acts as a sign of authenticity.
- **Example 2: McQuail's theories on audience reception** can be used to discuss why the Dove campaign was so successful. It moved beyond a simple "transmission" model of communication to a "reception" model, where the campaign's meaning was actively co-created and debated by the audience, leading to massive engagement.
- **Example 3:** The "Whispers of the White Desert" proposal is a direct application of the **PESO model**. The blog and website are **Owned** media. The influencer collaborations and UGC campaign are **Shared** media. The outreach to National Geographic is a strategy to generate **Earned** media. A small, targeted ad spend would constitute the **Paid** component.

7.3. Potential Exam Question Styles

Preparation should focus on questions that require critical evaluation and application of module concepts, rather than simple recall.

- **Critical Evaluation Question:** "Critically evaluate the impact of digital technology on the consumer/provider relationship, using a campaign of your choice as an example."
 - *Approach:* Define the traditional relationship. Explain how Web 2.0, social media, and review sites have shifted power to the consumer. Use a campaign (e.g., Dove) to illustrate how brands now engage in dialogue, community building, and reputation management in real-time. Discuss both positive (e.g., transparency) and negative (e.g., performative activism) impacts.
- **Strategic Application Question:** "Design a digital IMC strategy for a new sustainable fashion brand. Justify your choice of channels and messaging based on the principles of customer-centric marketing and the PESO model."
 - *Approach:* Start by creating a target audience persona. Use the 7 Ps to define the brand's digital presence. Propose a PESO mix, justifying each element (e.g., "We will focus on Shared media through ethical fashion influencers to build trust, as our audience is skeptical of traditional Paid advertising"). Outline how you would measure success using the Outputs-Outtakes-Outcomes framework.
- **Ethical Discussion Question:** "Discuss the ethical implications of using AI-assisted consumer behaviour analysis in a digital marketing campaign."
 - *Approach:* Acknowledge the benefits (e.g., personalization, relevance). Then, explore the ethical challenges, such as data privacy (GDPR), the potential for manipulative targeting (dark patterns), algorithmic bias, and the transparency of data collection. Reference the module's ethical guardrails as a framework for responsible practice.

References (Part III)

Ang, L. (2021). *Principles of Integrated Marketing Communications*. Cambridge University Press.

Blakeman, R. (2023). *Integrated Marketing Communication: Creative Strategy from Idea to Implementation*. Rowman & Littlefield.

Canva. (n.d.). *Create and collaborate on social media posts*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.canva.com/social-media/>

Datawrapper. (n.d.). *Datawrapper*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from

<https://www.datawrapper.de/>

diagrams.net. (n.d.). *diagrams.net*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.diagrams.net/>

Fiske, J. (2010). *Introduction to Communication Studies*. Routledge.

Google. (n.d.-a). *Google Alerts*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.google.com/alerts>

Google. (n.d.-b). *Lighthouse*. Chrome for Developers. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://developer.chrome.com/docs/lighthouse/overview>

Google. (n.d.-c). *PageSpeed Insights*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://developers.google.com/speed/pagespeed/insights/>

Google. (n.d.-d). *Google Trends*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://trends.google.com/trends/>

Hofstede Insights. (n.d.). *Country comparison tool*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.hofstede-insights.com/country-comparison-tool>

Hoaxy. (n.d.). *Hoaxy*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://hoaxy.iuni.iu.edu/>

Jitsi. (n.d.). *Jitsi Meet*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://meet.jit.si/>

Juska, J. M. (2021). *Integrated Marketing Communication: Advertising and Promotion in a Digital World*. Routledge.

Loom. (n.d.). *What is Loom?* Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://support.loom.com/hc/en-us/articles/360002158057-What-is-Loom>

McQuail, D., & Deuze, M. (2020). *McQuail's Media and Mass Communication Theory* (7th ed.). Sage.

Meta. (n.d.). *Meta Ad Library*. Transparency Center. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/>

Microsoft. (n.d.). *Clarity*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://clarity.microsoft.com/>

Miller, E. (n.d.). *Evan's awesome A/B tools*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.evanmiller.org/ab-testing/>

Neil Patel. (n.d.). *Ubersuggest*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://neilpatel.com/ubersuggest/>

OpenAI. (n.d.). *ChatGPT*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://chat.openai.com/>

Otter.ai. (n.d.). *Otter.ai*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://otter.ai/>

Ought. (n.d.). *Elicit*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://ought.org/elicit>

TikTok. (n.d.). *Creative Center*. TikTok For Business. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://ads.tiktok.com/business/creativecenter/>

Trello. (n.d.). *Trello*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://trello.com/>

Voyant Tools. (n.d.). *Voyant Tools*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://voyant-tools.org/>

World Values Survey. (n.d.). *WVS online*. Retrieved October 12, 2025, from <https://www.worldvaluessurvey.org/wvs.jsp>

Works cited

1. Breaking Stereotypes Through Moment Marketing: A Case ... - IJFMR, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.ijfmr.com/papers/2025/3/49579.pdf>
2. The good, the bad, and the ugly of the Dove Campaign for Real ..., accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.in-mind.org/article/the-good-the-bad-and-the-ugly-of-the-dove-campaign-for-real-beauty>
3. Dove and Real Beauty: Building a Brand with Purpose - Case ..., accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.hbs.edu/faculty/Pages/item.aspx?num=56459>
4. Dove's "Real Beauty" Campaign: A Critical Analysis of an Integrated ..., accessed October 12, 2025, https://surface.syr.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=2165&context=honors_capstone
5. Analyzing Dove's brand knowledge conveyance: A case study on the "Real Beauty" campaign - SHS Web of Conferences, accessed October 12, 2025, https://www.shs-conferences.org/articles/shsconf/pdf/2024/27/shsconf_icdeba2024_02003.pdf
6. The Effectiveness of the Dove Campaign for Real Beauty in Terms of Society and the Brand - SURFACE at Syracuse University, accessed October 12, 2025, https://surface.syr.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1479&context=honors_capstone
7. Case Study: Dove's Campaign for Real Beauty - MBA Knowledge ..., accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.mbaknol.com/management-case-studies/case-study-doves-campaign-for-real-beauty/>
8. From Comparison to Confidence: The Dove Self-Esteem Project and the Transformation of Beauty Perceptions on Social Media - PMC - PubMed Central, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12024319/>
9. Always #LikeAGirl: Turning an Insult into a Confidence Movement SITUATION

ANALYSIS The research was clear: at puberty, a girl', accessed October 12, 2025, <https://instituteofpr.org/wp-content/uploads/Always-LikeAGirl-Turning-an-Insult-into-a-Confidence-Movement.pdf>

10. Module Guide_Online PR and Marketing_DY3_IMC_S1_25-26 (1).docx
11. Dove's "Real Beauty" Campaign: Body Positive Promotion or ..., accessed October 12, 2025, <https://cases.open.ubc.ca/doves-real-beauty-campaign-body-positive-promotion-or-genderwashing/>
12. Real Beauty: How a Soap Brand Created a Global Self-Esteem Movement (case study), accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PbEysOm7uZw>
13. How Purposeful Always and Dove Campaigns Delivered Business Impact | Aaker on Brands, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://prophet.com/2015/05/230-how-like-a-girl-real-beauty-deliver-business-impact/>
14. Real Beauty Redefined for the AI Era (case study) - Dove - YouTube, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8vYoL8nga-A>
15. Case study | Dove (Unilever): 20 years on – Dove and the future of Real Beauty, accessed October 12, 2025, [https://wfanet.org/knowledge/diversity-and-inclusion/item/2024/06/13/case-study-dove-\(unilever\)-20-years-on-dove-and-the-future-of-real-beauty](https://wfanet.org/knowledge/diversity-and-inclusion/item/2024/06/13/case-study-dove-(unilever)-20-years-on-dove-and-the-future-of-real-beauty)
16. Sustainable Tourism | Western Desert Tours, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.westerndeserttours.com/about-us/sustainable-tourism/>
17. Visit the natural rich oasis in the Western Desert, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://desertroseecolodge.com/>
18. Sustaining Egypt's Tourism Industry - LOGIC Consulting, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://logic-consulting.com/sustaining-egypts-tourism-industry/>
19. Bringing-to-light: "ECO EGYPT" - Egypt's Hidden Gems | United Nations Development Programme, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.undp.org/egypt/stories/bringing-light-eco-egypt-egypts-hidden-gems>
20. Global Adventure Tourism Market Size, Trends, Share 2033, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.custommarketinsights.com/report/adventure-tourism-market/>
21. Western Desert and Oases Egypt: Nature, History & Wonders - Memphis Tours, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.memphistours.com/egypt/egypt-wikis/egypt-destinations/wiki/the-western-desert-and-oases>
22. Egypt launches its first campaign to promote its protected areas and ecotourism, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.undp.org/egypt/press-releases/egypt-launches-its-first-campaign-promote-its-protected-areas-and-ecotourism>
23. Innovative use of e-tourism – Egypt's strategy 2020, Advisory Council of the Tourism Ministry, Egypt, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://tourism4sdgs.org/initiatives/innovative-use-of-e-tourism-egypts-strategy-2020-advisory-council-of-the-tourism-ministry-egypt/>

24. Heritage Tourism Market Size, Share & Trends Report, 2030 - Grand View Research, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/heritage-tourism-market-report>
25. Cultural Tourism Market Size & Share | Industry Trends, 2035 - Business Research Insights, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.businessresearchinsights.com/market-reports/cultural-tourism-market-107478>
26. Western Desert and Oases - Djed Egypt Travel, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.djedegypt.com/western-desert-and-oases/>
27. Design Amazing Social Media Graphics and Content with Canva, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.canva.com/social-media/>
28. Everything you need to know about social media marketing - Canva, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.canva.com/learn/everything-you-need-to-know-about-social-media-marketing/>
29. pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10089336/#:~:text=It%20is%20a%20free%20artificial,expedites%20the%20literature%20review%20process.>
30. Elicit | Ought, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://ought.org/elicit>
31. Evan's Awesome A/B Tools - sample size calculator, A/B test results, and more, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.evanmiller.org/ab-testing/>
32. Sample Size Calculator (Evan's Awesome A/B Tools) - Evan Miller, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.evanmiller.org/ab-testing/sample-size.html>
33. About PageSpeed Insights - Google for Developers, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://developers.google.com/speed/docs/insights/v4/about>
34. developer.chrome.com, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://developer.chrome.com/docs/lighthouse/overview#:~:text=Lighthouse%20is%20an%20open%2Dsource.or%20as%20a%20Node%20module.>
35. ads.tiktok.com, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://ads.tiktok.com/help/article/creative-center#:~:text=TikTok%20For%20Business%20Creative%20Center.to%20create%20effective%20TikTok%20ads.>
36. transparency.meta.com, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://transparency.meta.com/researchtools/ad-library-tools#:~:text=Meta%20Ad%20Library%20is%20a,running%20across%20products%20from%20Meta.>
37. www.m1-project.com, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.m1-project.com/blog/generative-ai-for-marketing-tools-examples-and-case-studies#:~:text=In%20addition%2C%20generative%20AI's%20ability,respond%20to%20customers'%20future%20needs.>
38. Generative AI for Marketing: Tools, Examples, and Case Studies | M1-Project, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.m1-project.com/blog/generative-ai-for-marketing-tools-examples-and-case-studies>
39. ChatGPT for marketing - OpenAI Academy, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://academy.openai.com/public/clubs/work-users-ynjqu/resources/use-cases->

marketing

40. Top 20 ChatGPT in Marketing Use Cases - Research AIMultiple, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://research.aimultiple.com/chatgpt-in-marketing/>
41. Google Cloud introduces Gemini Enterprise, an AI platform for businesses, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/technology/artificial-intelligence/google-cloud-introduces-gemini-enterprise-an-ai-platform-for-businesses/articleshow/124417154.cms>
42. Google launches Gemini Enterprise, a new platform for workplace automation using AI agents, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://indianexpress.com/article/technology/artificial-intelligence/google-launches-gemini-enterprise-a-new-platform-ai-agents-10297341/>
43. en.wikipedia.org, accessed October 12, 2025, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Voyant_Tools
44. Anatomy of an online misinformation network - PMC - PubMed Central, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5922526/>
45. en.wikipedia.org, accessed October 12, 2025, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Google_Trends
46. www.norec.no, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://www.norec.no/en/resources/country-comparison-tool/#::~text=The%20Hofstede%20model%20allows%20you.initiate%20discussions%20about%20cultural%20differences.>
47. en.wikipedia.org, accessed October 12, 2025, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/World_Values_Survey
48. Datawrapper - data.europa.eu, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://data.europa.eu/apps/data-visualisation-guide/datawrapper>
49. diagrams.net - Wikipedia, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Diagrams.net>
50. Microsoft Clarity - Microsoft AppSource, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://appsource.microsoft.com/en-us/product/office/wa200004850?tab=overview>
51. chromewebstore.google.com, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/ubersuggest-seo-and-keywo/nmpgaooofmjlimabncmnmnopjabbflegf?hl=en#:~:text=Ubersuggest%20is%20a%20FREE%20chrome,Yes!>
52. en.wikipedia.org, accessed October 12, 2025, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Google_Alerts
53. Trello for project management: 2025 Complete Guide - Planyway, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://planyway.com/blog/how-to-use-trello-for-project-management>
54. Jitsi - Wikipedia, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jitsi>
55. support.loom.com, accessed October 12, 2025, <https://support.loom.com/hc/en-us/articles/360002158057-What-is-Loom#:~:text=Loom%20is%20a%20video%20messaging,share%20through%20Loom's%20patented%20technology.>

56. dsp.berkeley.edu, accessed October 12, 2025,
<https://dsp.berkeley.edu/auxiliary-service-units/note-taking-services/note-taking-technologies/otter-ai#:~:text=Otter%20AI%20is%20a%20transcription,transcription%20of%20audio%2Fvideo%20files>.